

Education	The University of Texas at Dallas <i>Ph.D. in Computer Science</i> advised by Zhiyu Zoey Chen	2024–2027 (anticipated) Dallas, TX
	Soochow University <i>M.S. in Computer Science</i> advised by Wenliang Chen ◦ Outstanding Graduate	2020–2023 Suzhou, China
	Nanjing University of Posts and Telecommunications <i>B.Eng. in Computer Science</i> ◦ Top 3% in the Department; Principal’s Award	2016–2020 Nanjing, China

Research Interests Reinforcement Learning · LLM/VLM Agents · Reliability · Efficiency

Employment	Scale Labs <i>Research Intern</i> (Hosts: Manasi Sharma , Daniel Yue Zhang , Ying Liu) ◦ Topic: Multi-agent Computer Use	Jun. 2026–Aug. 2026 San Francisco, CA
	Zoom GenAI <i>Research Intern</i> (Hosts: Kaiqiang Song , Zheng Chen) ◦ Topic: Complex Instruction Following	Jun. 2025–Aug. 2025 Seattle, WA
	Tencent AI Lab <i>Research Intern</i> (Hosts: Lifeng Jin , Linfeng Song , Haitao Mi) ◦ Topics: Preference Alignment, Dialogue System	May 2024–Jul. 2024 Seattle, WA

Papers (Selected) The full publication list is at [Google Scholar](#). * denotes equal contribution.

[1] [Spine-Branch Coordination for Multi-agent Computer Use](#) [Preprint](#)
👤 **Mian Zhang**, Manasi Sharma, Sheng Zhang, Minlai Yang, Kejian Shi, Ying Liu, Zhiyu Zoey Chen, Daniel Yue Zhang

[2] [Mitigating Exploration Bias in RL for Multi-Instruction Following](#) [EMNLP 2026](#)
👤 **Mian Zhang**, Yueqin Yin, Kaiyu He, Peilin Wu, Xinlu Zhang, Mingyuan Zhou, Zhiyu Zoey Chen

[3] [LogicIF: Towards Complex Logic Instruction Following](#) [COLM 2026](#)
👤 **Mian Zhang**, Shujian Liu, Sixun Dong, Ming Yin, Yebowen Hu, Xun Wang, Steven Ma, Song Wang, Sathish Reddy Indurthi, Haoyun Deng, Zhiyu Zoey Chen, Kaiqiang Song

[4] [HiPRAG: Hierarchical Process Rewards for Efficient Agentic Retrieval Augmented Generation](#) [ICLR 2026](#)
👤 Peilin Wu, **Mian Zhang**, Kun Wang, Wentian Zhao, Kaiyu He, Xinya Du, Zhiyu Chen

[5] [Search Wisely: Mitigating Sub-optimal Agentic Searches By Reducing Uncertainty](#) [EMNLP 2025](#)
👤 **Mian Zhang***, Peilin Wu*, Xinlu Zhang, Xinya Du, Zhiyu Zoey Chen

[6] [Rubric Dropout: A Simple Way to Mitigate Reward Hacking in Rubric-as-Reward RL](#) [Preprint](#)
👤 Minglai Yang, Xinyu Guo, Utkarsh Tyagi, **Mian Zhang**, Razvan Dumitru, Sunjie Hou, Yunzhong He, Daniel Yue Zhang, Ying Liu

[7] **MMTok: Multimodal Coverage Maximization for Efficient Inference of VLMs** [ICLR 2026](#)
👤 Sixun Dong, Juhua Hu, **Mian Zhang**, Ming Yin, Yanjie Fu, Qi Qian

[8] **Preference Learning Unlocks LLMs’ Psycho-Counseling Skills** [ACL 2026](#)
👤 **Mian Zhang**, Shaun M. Eack, Zhiyu Zoey Chen

[9] **CBT-Bench: Evaluating Large Language Models on Assisting Cognitive Behavior Therapy** [NAACL 2025](#)
👤 **Mian Zhang**, Xianjun Yang, Xinlu Zhang, Travis Labrum, Jamie C. Chiu, Shaun M. Eack, Fei Fang, William Yang Wang, Zhiyu Zoey Chen

[10] **SafeConv: Explaining and Correcting Conversational Unsafe Behavior** [ACL 2023 Oral](#)
👤 **Mian Zhang**, Lifeng Jin, Linfeng Song, Haitao Mi, Wenliang Chen, Dong Yu.

Selected Awards	Tinker Research Grant from Thinking Machines	2025
	Researcher Access Program from OpenAI	2025
	Outstanding Graduate Award at Soochow University	2023
	First-class Scholarship at Soochow University	2020–2021
	Principal’s Award	2019
	Mathematical Contest in Modeling National First Prize (top 1%)	2018
	First-class Scholarship at NJUPT	2017–2019